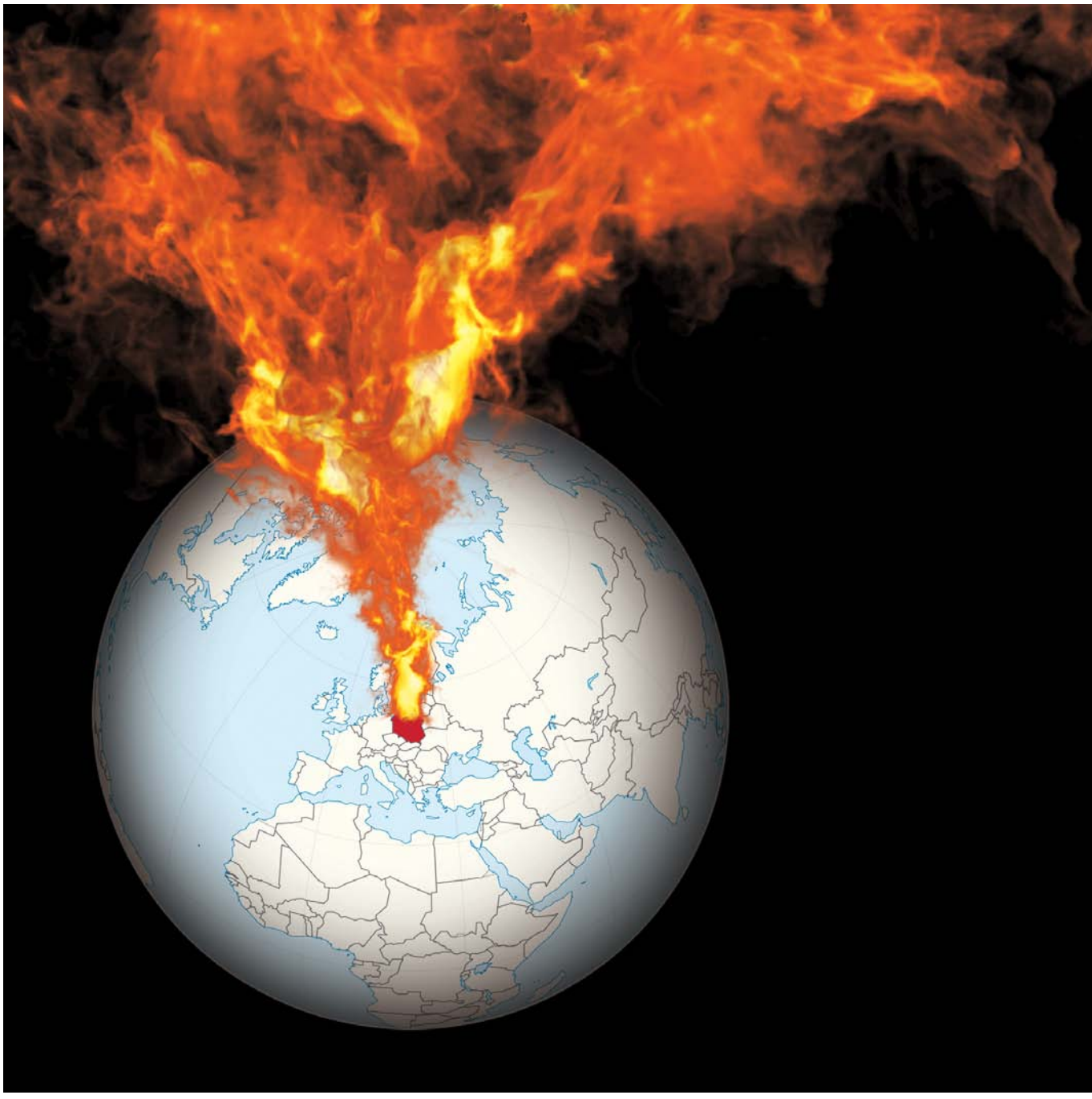


Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS**

economy, or destiny. War results from the choices leaders make.

If war is a matter of choice, so can be peace. General Mark Milley, chairman of the US Joint Chiefs of Staff, has advised Ukraine to negotiate a pragmatic solution. The Ukrainian leaders have responded hysterically, the way they did when Henry Kissinger had recommended constitutional neutrality in 2013. Despite the Pentagon's top boss uttering wise words, the United States supplies arms to Ukraine. This has created three possible scenarios for the future of the war in Ukraine.

SCENARIO I: CEASEFIRE AND PEACE PROCESS

If the Russians and Ukrainians want to escape mutually assured destruction, they may explore a ceasefire, followed by a peace process. The latter would involve the withdrawal of heavy weapons from the frontline, exchange of prisoners, a demilitarised zone under UN supervision and the beginning of talks for the Russian military withdrawal in return for Ukraine implementing the Minsk II provisions for the autonomy of Donbass.

The question is who will break the deadlock. There is a complete